OPTION 1:

A Proposed AgriHub: An Integrating Agricultural Support and Flood-Responsive Community Infrastructure

Thesis Statement:

A Farmers' Development and Community Resilience Hub can strengthen agricultural communities by providing spaces that support farmers' livelihoods, education, market access, and disaster preparedness within a single adaptive facility.

Among the different fields of architecture, I am highly interested in projects that directly respond to the needs of communities. For this reason, I would like to pursue a research paper entitled *A Farmers' Development and Community Resilience Hub: Integrating Agricultural Support and Flood-Responsive Community Infrastructure*. This topic is personally meaningful to me because I grew up in a province where farming is part of our family's way of life. My mother's side of the family has been involved in farming for many years, and growing up, I witnessed the hard work that farmers put into planting, harvesting, drying, and selling their crops.

Despite their efforts, I often heard them talk about challenges such as low crop prices, high irrigation costs, and the difficulty of earning a stable income. It was painful to see how much work farmers do only to receive very little in return. Because of these experiences, I began asking myself how architecture could contribute to improving their situation. If farmers play such an important role in feeding communities, why are there so few spaces specifically designed to support their growth, development, and resilience?

Through this study, I would like to explore the idea of a Farmers' Development and Community Resilience Hub, a facility that could provide training spaces, cooperative offices, product display and trading areas, community gathering spaces, and livelihood support programs. At the same time, the facility could function as a flood-responsive community center and evacuation space during emergencies. Instead of creating a building with only one purpose, the project aims to investigate how architecture can serve communities in multiple ways.

One of the central theoretical questions this research will engage with is how architecture can serve a dual purpose as both a livelihood support space and a disaster-resilient structure. Relevant frameworks include adaptive architecture and community-centered design, both of which emphasize how buildings can respond to the changing needs of specific communities. A key research gap this study aims to address is the limited literature on how agricultural support and flood-responsive design can be meaningfully integrated in a rural Philippine context.

The relevance of this study lies in the continuing challenges faced by agricultural communities in the Philippines, particularly in areas that are vulnerable to flooding and other climate-related hazards. While many facilities focus on either agricultural support or disaster response, this research seeks to examine how both functions can be integrated into a single adaptive and community-centered architectural solution. The country continues to experience frequent and intense flooding events in low-lying agricultural provinces, which disrupt farming operations and displace communities making the need for this kind of facility not only relevant but urgent.

Ultimately, this proposed research aims to investigate the potential of a Farmers' Development and Community Resilience Hub as a facility that not only supports agricultural productivity but also serves as a safe, accessible, and adaptable space for the community during times of need. By exploring this concept, the study hopes to contribute ideas for architectural solutions that recognize and support the significant role of farmers in society while enhancing the resilience of rural communities.